Data & Donuts

Fall 2026

Project STEEP - URI DMAC Team (2026-2027)



Melanie Brasher, Ph.D.

Associate Professor of Sociology

Research Affiliate, STEEP II DMAC

Research Background: research data management (RDM), demography, gerontology, secondary survey data analysis.

https://web.uri.edu/soc-anth/meet/melanie-s-brasher/



Michael Pürrer, Ph.D.

Computational Scientist, IACR

Adjunct Assistant Professor of Physics

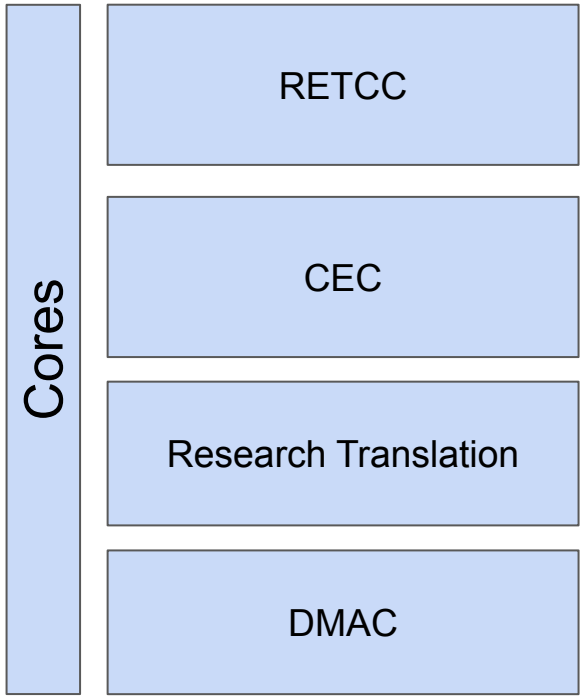
Research Background: gravitational wave source modeling and Bayesian inference, AI/ML methods, scientific machine learning.

https://web.uri.edu/gravity/meet/michael-purrer/

What is DMAC?

Data Management and Analysis Core (DMAC)

- Develop, coordinate, and monitor a user-friendly, easily-accessible infrastructure and processes for creating, storing, and sharing data and metadata, irrespective of size, both internally and publicly.
- Address metadata needs across all STEEP research data products.
- Provide integrative methodological and computational support, as well as develop mission-oriented methods.
- Develop standards for and provide data quality assurance and quality control (QA/QC) across STEEP projects.



How can DMAC help you?

- **Support with publishing research data – as part of manuscript publication and open science practices**
- help with data backup
- access to research computing, such as help with computationally intensive workflows
- help with internal data sharing
- Integrative statistical support: - Office hours/consulting from Marie-Abele Bind (MGH, Harvard Medical School), MBIND@mgh.harvard.edu
- for basic statistical consulting (URI), you can also reach out to: Shaghayegh ‘Shay’ Sahraei Joubani, Student Statistical Consultant and Trainer, s.sahraei@uri.edu

Support from Institute of AI & Computational Research (IACR)

Compute & storage — the Unity cluster

UNITY MGHPCC

- **Large shared cluster** at MGHPCC: ~30K CPU cores, ~360 modern GPUs, with URI-priority partitions
- **Works in your browser:** JupyterLab, RStudio, MATLAB and VS Code at ood.unity.uri.edu — no terminal required powered by OPEN OnDemand
- **Research storage** for backup and sharing within your lab: `/work` (1 TB), `/project` (NESE), OSN cloud buckets
- **Getting access:** your PI requests a group at unity.uri.edu and adds you to it; onboarding sessions

Training, software & consulting

- **Workshops:** AI Lab (Carothers Library, Rm 147): Python, R, machine learning, generative AI, HPC; Fall 2026 workshops
- **Unity onboarding** sessions every month; drop-in office hours Tue 2:30–4 PM
- **No-install tools:** jupyter.uri.edu, rstudio.uri.edu (for courses); licensed statistical software SAS, SPSS, JMP Pro, ATLAS.ti, MATLAB
- **One-on-one help** from computational scientists: scaling an analysis, ML methods, data workflows

Get help: hpc@etal.uri.edu (Unity support ticket) · iacr-group@uri.edu · iacr.uri.edu

Institute for Artificial Intelligence & Computational Research

DMAC team (2026-2027)

Dr. Michael Pürrer (remote)

Help with data management (publishing, metadata) and research computing (Unity, AI/ML)

Zoom office hours Tue 11am, or by appointment (please email mpuerrer@uri.edu)

Professor Melanie Brasher (URI Kingston campus)

Help with general questions about STEEP DMAC resources; data-related conference presentations

mbrasher@uri.edu

Dr. Marie-Abele Bind (remote)

Help with experimental design and statistical questions (pre and post data collection), including missing data, limit of detection, statistical inference

Please request a meeting by email: mbind@mgh.harvard.edu